

Once the sketch is on the artboard, I can resize it, move it, and lower its transparency to 50%. If you're using a graphic, lower the opacity to 50% (or more if the sketch is too dark), lock the layer, and make a new layer under the sketch layer. This will be your artwork layer.

Step 4: You can break up any complicated shape into simple shapes. We used the Ellipse Tool (L) to trace the head for this design. We then used the Selection Tool to move and rotate the shapes (V).

When the basic shapes are roughly where you want them, use the Shape Builder Tool (Shift+M) to combine them by dragging the cursor over them.

Step 5: Use the Pen Tool (P) to draw the basic shape if you need to make small curves. Make a point in the middle of each turn. This is where the lines will be smoothed.

Hold down the Shift key to make curves from points and drag the end with the Convert Anchor Point Tool (Shift+C). Use the Reflect Tool to make symmetry more simple (O). To reflect a shape, select it with the Selection Tool (V), then choose the Reflect Tool (O) and Option + Shift + O. Click where the body will be reflected on the artboard. You should now see a settings box. Set the axis to how you want the shape to be mirrored (my image is reproduced vertically), then click Copy. You now have a copy of your body that is flipped. Use the Shape Builder Tool (Shift+M) to combine the shapes and the Convert Anchor Point Tool (Shift+C) to smooth out any rough edges.

Step 6: Now comes the good part. There's a way to see your icon's appearance while making it. Go to Window> New Window to start. This creates a copy of the document you're currently working on.

Hide the Grid once you've made the new Window. Set the Window to Concrete Size, hide the artboards, and choose Pixel Preview from the "View" menu. You will now have a pretty good idea of how your finished icon will look. The best part about working with the second Window is that anything you change in the first Window will also change in the double Window.

Step 7: Use the Round Rectangle Tool and Option+Click on the artboard to make a button behind the icon. Then a settings menu will come up. Set the Width and Height to a few pixels less than the final size of your hero. This will give you room to add drop shadows or other effects later. Depending on the size of your icon, you'll need to choose a different corner radius.

Once you've made the rounded rectangle, to hide it, use Command + Left Square Bracket Key and drag it behind the symbol.

Step 8: Fill the rounded rectangle with the Gradient Tool (G), then set the bottom swatch of the rise to a mid-gray and the top swatch to a very